

GitHub to buy JavaScript packaging vendor, NPM

Microsoft owned GitHub is reported to be purchasing NPM, which offers vital assistance for JavaScript developers.

This is a significant development because these days, developers build programs by compiling together smaller programs from open source packages of code. NPM hosts such code packages. NPM co-founder Isaac Schlueter claims in a blog post that the company hosts 1.3 million packages, which are downloaded 75 billion times per month. As per the company's website, its customers include Slack, Netflix, Visa and Nike, among others.

If people wish to create an open source Node package and share it with other programmers, they would upload the code to GitHub, and also to NPM, from where other developers would install and manage it. Last year, GitHub had also launched its own package management service, known as the GitHub Package Registry.

Like GitHub, NPM also charges users who want to host code privately instead of putting it in the public domain. Perhaps companies use this strategy to administer proprietary software and open source software through the same setup.

NPM had raised US\$ 8 million in venture capital in 2015. But even with its vital role in the software development arena, NPM struggled. Last year, *The Register* reported that the company had let go of around 25 per cent of its employees.

2019 was not a good year for NPM as it found itself in hot waters with five complaints with the National Labour Relations Board (NLRB), being accused of 'coercive statements' and retribution. According to the NLRB website, all the grievances have been settled with informal settlements.

The terms of the GitHub-NPM deal have not yet been disclosed.

Blackboard plans to sell open source LMS platform to LTG for US\$ 32 million

According to *Educationdive*, Blackboard plans to sell its open learning management system (LMS) to London based Learning Technologies Group Plc (LTG). The report said that this deal has been valued at US\$ 31.7 million. Blackboard's chief learning and innovation officer, Phillip Miller, will lead the open LMS business at LTG, as a part of the deal.



Open LMS is a Software-as-a-Service platform based on Moodle (an open source LMS). Blackboard will continue to give existing Open LMS clients access to its products that integrate with the platform. This will include tools to help provide classes and make course content more accessible.

Sources at LTG have said that the acquisition is a significant step towards growing its position in the Moodle marketplace. It also said that the company, which is focused on educational technologies for the workplace, will ensure it protects students' data privacy.

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